

Teacher card

Diwali: festival, story and meaning / GROW_RE_A1_W03

Outcome: Explain one meaning connected to Diwali.

Evidence to retain: F: one symbol → meaning response.

Forty minute route

Arrival 4 min; starter 3; model 6; shared task 7; check 2; independent 12; review 3; exit 3.
Pause time is flexible.

Preparation

Choose one independent route. Print the evidence and shared cards, required visual or data sheet, route worksheet and exit. The organiser is one separate A4 page. Keep answers with staff.

Use careful language about diversity within traditions; distinguish story, practice and meaning; use desk packs if movement is dysregulating.

Access and regulation

Image-led input; reduced symbol set; read-aloud; matching before writing; sentence stems; draw/label option.

Offer a predictable start, private response and agreed pause. No cold calling or forced personal disclosure. Rejoin at one clearly named next step. Keep teen-appropriate examples and the same learning goal across response modes.

This is learning about religion and worldviews, not worship. Nobody is asked to share a personal belief, family detail or loss.

Assessment

Use questioning and the exit response to decide the next step. Record the learner's individual contribution and the access support used.

UAS: no approved unit code is supplied. Match the learner's evidence to the centre-selected unit and exact criteria before submission. This pack makes no automatic award claim.

Model and answers

Read these pages before teaching. Hide the model during independent assessment.

Question: Name one thing light can represent at Diwali.

Evidence: A Rama and Sita: Many Hindus tell the story of Rama and Sita at Diwali. After Rama rescues Sita from Ravana, people light lamps to guide them home. Light stands for good overcoming evil.

Think aloud: Good overcoming evil, hope or welcome.

Check: Is Diwali celebrated only by Hindus? No. Many Sikhs and Jains also celebrate at this time, with their own meanings.

Arrival answers

1. Generosity: caring for those in need.
2. A festival of lights celebrated by many Hindus, Sikhs and Jains
3. Good overcoming evil, hope or welcome.
4. No. Many Sikhs and Jains also celebrate at this time, with their own meanings.

Shared activity reasoning

1. Rows of lit diyas — Good overcoming evil. Card A: lamps guide Rama and Sita home.
2. Rangoli by the door — Welcome. Card C: rangoli welcome guests.
3. Sharing sweets with visitors — Community and joy. Card C: families visit and share.

Exit responses

Name one thing light can represent at Diwali. Good overcoming evil, hope or welcome.

Is Diwali celebrated only by Hindus? No. Many Sikhs and Jains also celebrate at this time, with their own meanings.

Teaching and evidence record

Supplied scheme of work teaching sequence: Arrival: 4 retrieval questions. Starter: mystery images — diya, rangoli, lights, sweets. I Do: introduce Diwali through a short story/source and explain that it is celebrated in different ways by Hindu, Sikh and Jain communities. We Do: match symbols/practices to meanings. You Do: create a 'Diwali: symbol → meaning' response. Exit ticket: one thing light can represent at Diwali.

Look for

F: one symbol → meaning response.

Accept accurate equivalents, including speech or exact scribing. Check the concept and use of evidence rather than length or handwriting. Record access support separately from content prompting.

BUILD: a concrete example with a reason or demonstrated action. GROW: explain or compare with a relevant detail. LAUNCH: connect evidence and reasoning; use a limitation when the outcome requires it. Keep RE responses non-GCSE.

Media

Original captioned teaching model made for this pack. It demonstrates the supplied reasoning; it is not historical footage, survivor testimony or a documentary. The full transcript and factual source credits are included.

Use manual steps for a calm pace. The silent MP4 has visible captions and a matching text transcript. External archive media is optional and should be previewed before class.

Source credits

Hindu American Foundation Diwali <https://www.hinduamerican.org/diwali>

Sikh Coalition introduction to Sikh beliefs and practice
<https://www.sikhcoalition.org/about-sikhs/>

Source access was checked on 19 September 2026. Restricted links are listed in Sources_and_checks.html; a restriction here is not proof that the page is dead. Offline teaching material remains available.